

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Data Analytics and Business Intelligence English



Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For data analysts, BI developers, analytics engineers, data scientists, reporting teams, business analysts, and data-driven managers.

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Metric Definitions and Business Questions

Clarify missing information before responding.

02 Data Quality and Trust

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

03 Dashboards and Executive Reporting

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

04 Causation, Correlation, and Caveats

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

05 SQL, Models, and Transformation Logic

Clarify missing information before responding.

06 Experiment Readouts and Statistical Thinking

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

07 Data Governance and Privacy

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

08 Insight Storytelling and Recommendations

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop, or use the prompts at the end of this guide.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Metric Definitions and Business Questions

Clarify missing information before responding.

SITUATION

Two teams report different active-user totals. One counts logins; the other counts completed transactions.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

metric - A defined quantitative measure used to track or assess something.

business definition - An agreed explanation of what a measure or term means in an organization.

source of truth - The agreed authoritative reference for a particular item of organizational information.

owner - Named person or role accountable for a decision, action, deliverable, or risk.

3. Notice the language

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Compare this wording: Could you explain what does this mean?

LESSON 01 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask a precise question

4. Check the language

1. Which indirect question has the usual word order?
 - A. Could you confirm when does the review start?
 - B. Could you confirm when starts the review?
 - C. Could you confirm when the review starts?
2. Someone says the report is 'ready.' Which question best clarifies its approval status?
 - A. Who will present the report at the meeting?
 - B. Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?
 - C. Can you send the report to me this afternoon?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Active by login or completed transaction?

Fictional metric discussion using the lesson case: two teams report different active-user totals because one counts logins and the other completed transactions.

01 • Operations manager: Your active-user total differs from the product team's. Which dashboard should we call the source of truth?

02 • BI analyst: First clarify the business definition. Their metric counts logins, while ours counts users completing transactions.

03 • Operations manager: Then the disagreement isn't necessarily a calculation error; the label hides two different activities.

04 • BI analyst: Exactly. Which business question do you need the number to answer in this meeting?

05 • Operations manager: I want to know how many people completed the service task, not merely entered the system.

06 • BI analyst: Then transaction-based activity is relevant, but we should still confirm its period and counting rules.

07 • Operations manager: Could both measures remain useful if their names distinguish them rather than competing for one vague label?

08 • BI analyst: Yes. Assign an owner to each definition and avoid presenting the totals as interchangeable.

09 • Operations manager: I'll ask the product team to review the labels with us before we publish another comparison.

10 • BI analyst: I'll bring the current definitions and mark any unresolved exclusions so the discussion stays precise.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An order placed is not an order fulfilled

Fictional operations reporting: sales counts orders placed, while fulfillment counts orders shipped; both reports use the label orders this week.

01 • Sales operations lead: Our weekly order count is higher than fulfillment's. Could the warehouse be missing records?

02 • Analytics lead: Possibly, but first check the event definition. Sales counts placement, and fulfillment counts shipment.

03 • Sales operations lead: So an order placed this week may belong to another week's shipment count.

04 • Analytics lead: Correct. We need the business question before deciding which metric is appropriate.

05 • Sales operations lead: For staffing, the warehouse wants the work actually shipped during the week, not demand arriving.

06 • Analytics lead: Then use the shipment-based definition for that purpose and retain placement counts for demand analysis.

07 • Sales operations lead: Could you also clarify whether a split shipment counts once or more than once?

08 • Analytics lead: That rule isn't established here. I'll ask the metric owner rather than assume a counting grain.

09 • Sales operations lead: Let's label the two reports clearly and keep the split-shipment question open until confirmed.

10 • Analytics lead: Agreed. A source of truth needs an explicit definition, not simply a preferred dashboard name.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Revenue before or after refunds?

Fictional reporting clarification: two internal summaries use revenue but one subtracts refunds; tax treatment and reporting period are unspecified.

01 • Commercial manager: These revenue totals disagree. Could you clarify whether both include the same transactions and adjustments?

02 • BI analyst: One subtracts refunds, while the other doesn't. Tax treatment and reporting period also need confirmation.

03 • Commercial manager: Then choosing the larger number would not resolve the business-definition problem.

04 • BI analyst: Correct. We should identify what decision this summary supports and obtain the approved definition from its owner.

05 • Commercial manager: I need an operational comparison, not advice about accounting recognition or what to report externally.

06 • BI analyst: Understood. I'll keep the discussion within the internal metric and refer accounting questions to the appropriate specialist.

07 • Commercial manager: Please ask the owner about refunds, tax treatment, and the time boundary before reconciling the totals.

08 • BI analyst: I will. I'll also retain both source calculations rather than overwrite one without understanding the difference.

09 • Commercial manager: Once the definitions are clear, we can decide whether the reports should use different names.

10 • BI analyst: Exactly. The first outcome is a shared meaning, followed by a comparison using consistent rules.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Metric Definitions and Business Questions

Two teams report different active-user totals. One counts logins; the other counts completed transactions.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: What action qualifies a user as active, and over what period? The two totals use different definitions. Let's agree on the business question and label each measure clearly.

Scenario 2 | Does a reopened ticket count again?

A fictional service dashboard reports tickets resolved this month. The brief does not say whether a ticket resolved twice after reopening counts once or twice. The support manager needs a workload measure. Clarify the event and counting unit.

Role A: BI analyst: ask whether the question concerns unique tickets or resolution actions.

Role B: Support manager: explain the workload purpose and identify the definition owner.

Possible opening: For workload, do you want unique tickets or each resolution action, including work after reopening?

Success checks

- Distinguish objects from repeated events.
- Connect the definition to the business question.
- Agree a precise label and owner review.

Add a complication: The manager asks to keep the same label for both measures.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Data Quality and Trust

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

SITUATION

A dashboard refreshed today, but one source table contains data only through Monday. A manager assumes all figures are current.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

data quality - How well data meets requirements for its intended use, such as accuracy and completeness.

freshness - How recently data reflects events in the source system.

completeness - The extent to which required information or records are present.

pipeline - A sequence of stages through which data, work, or sales opportunities move.

3. Notice the language

Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

We have completed ...; ... remains open.

As of ..., the status is

The next update will cover

Compare this wording: Everything is progressing well.

LESSON 02 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Give a useful status update

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence says a review is finished?
 - A. The team plans to complete the review.
 - B. The team has completed the review.
 - C. The team is completing the review.
2. Which update distinguishes a plan from a confirmed fact?
 - A. Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.
 - B. Delivery is confirmed for Friday because we planned it.
 - C. The delivery plan proves that arrival will be Friday.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A refreshed dashboard contains Monday's source data

Fictional data-quality update using the lesson case: the dashboard refreshed today, but one source table contains data only through Monday.

01 • Business manager: The dashboard refreshed today. Can I assume every figure includes activity through this morning?

02 • Data analyst: No. One source table only contains data through Monday, despite today's dashboard refresh.

03 • Business manager: Then the display update completed, but the underlying source freshness is different.

04 • Data analyst: Exactly. The pipeline can refresh a report without receiving newer records from every source.

05 • Business manager: Does that prove the Monday data is inaccurate, or only that later activity is missing?

06 • Data analyst: The known issue is the coverage date. We haven't established that the existing records are incorrect.

07 • Business manager: Please make the affected source and cutoff visible so readers don't treat all totals as current.

08 • Data analyst: I'll label that boundary and ask the source owner for the pending update status.

09 • Business manager: Can you promise the missing activity will appear tomorrow if the dashboard runs again?

10 • Data analyst: Not without source confirmation. I'll report the next verified update rather than assume refresh means completeness.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A successful pipeline with a missing region

Fictional reporting handoff: a pipeline run succeeded, but its input manifest contains files from three of four expected regions.

01 • Operations director: The pipeline is green. Does that confirm the regional report is complete for all four regions?

02 • Data engineer: The run succeeded technically, but the input manifest includes only three of the four expected regions.

03 • Operations director: So the success status tells us the available input was processed, not that all input arrived.

04 • Data engineer: Correct. Completeness remains unresolved for the missing region even though the processing step finished.

05 • Operations director: Should its missing values be displayed as zero sales until the file arrives?

06 • Data engineer: No. Missing data isn't evidence of zero activity. We should label that region's figures unavailable.

07 • Operations director: Please request the source status and explain which comparisons are affected by the gap.

08 • Data engineer: I'll contact the regional data owner and retain the input manifest with the update.

09 • Operations director: Then today's report can show completed processing and incomplete coverage without concealing either.

10 • Data engineer: Agreed. I'll confirm when the missing source is received and checked before calling the report complete.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Corrected records have not reached the report

Fictional data-quality case: duplicate source records were corrected, but the dashboard has not rerun since that correction.

01 • Source owner: We corrected the duplicate records. Can you tell users the dashboard totals are fixed now?

02 • BI analyst: The source correction is complete, but the dashboard hasn't rerun since that change.

03 • Source owner: Then the displayed totals may still reflect the earlier records until processing and verification finish.

04 • BI analyst: Exactly. We need to distinguish source repair, pipeline refresh, and checking the resulting report.

05 • Source owner: Could a scheduled refresh be treated as completed remediation because it usually succeeds?

06 • BI analyst: No. A planned run isn't an observed result, and we still need to verify the affected totals.

07 • Source owner: I'll provide the correction record and identify the affected keys through the normal data-quality channel.

08 • BI analyst: Thank you. I'll use that scope to check the refresh outcome without changing unrelated figures.

09 • Source owner: Please keep the user update clear about what has been repaired and what remains pending.

10 • BI analyst: I will. We'll confirm the displayed correction after the run and validation, not before.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Data Quality and Trust

A dashboard refreshed today, but one source table contains data only through Monday. A manager assumes all figures are current.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Second round: The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Model for scenario 1: The dashboard refreshed today, but that table is current only through Monday. I'll show the source's data cutoff separately from the dashboard refresh time.

Scenario 2 | A late file has arrived but failed checks

A fictional missing source file has arrived, but its row-count check failed and the reason is unknown. It has not been included in the report. Explain completed receipt, pending validation, and the effect on completeness.

Role A: Data engineer: report the file's actual processing status.

Role B: Business owner: ask whether arrival alone means the dashboard is complete.

Possible opening: The file arrived, but it has not passed validation or entered the report yet.

Success checks

- Separate receipt from validated inclusion.
- Do not invent the reason for the failed check.
- Agree an owner update before changing the completeness claim.

Add a complication: The business owner asks to remove the missing-data notice immediately.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Dashboards and Executive Reporting

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

SITUATION

A KPI card shows a monthly total without its target, comparison period, or definition. The reader cannot interpret whether the result is favorable.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

dashboard - Visual summary of selected measures used to monitor status, performance, or risk.

KPI - Key performance indicator used to monitor progress against an important objective.

threshold - A defined value or condition that triggers a decision or changes a classification.

drill-down - Moving from a summary measure to more detailed information behind it.

3. Notice the language

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Compare this wording: We need to operationalize the implementation.

LESSON 03 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Make a complex point clear

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence explains 'backlog' rather than repeating it?
 - A. The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.
 - B. The backlog is the work completed during the last period.
 - C. The backlog is the maximum work the team can finish in a period.
2. Which follow-up best checks whether your explanation was clear?
 - A. Would you like me to repeat the explanation?
 - B. Was the explanation detailed enough for you?
 - C. How would you describe the next step in your own words?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A monthly total without an interpretation frame

Fictional dashboard review using the lesson case: a KPI card has a monthly total but no target, comparison period, or definition.

01 • Executive reader: This monthly total looks large. Is that a good result for the business?

02 • Dashboard designer: The card doesn't provide enough context. We need the metric definition, relevant comparison, and any agreed target.

03 • Executive reader: Could you color it green so readers know what conclusion to draw immediately?

04 • Dashboard designer: Not until a favorable threshold is established. A color shouldn't invent an assessment the evidence doesn't support.

05 • Executive reader: Please explain the difference between a number and a key performance indicator, or KPI.

06 • Dashboard designer: A KPI connects a defined measure to a performance question; the isolated total doesn't show that connection.

07 • Executive reader: Would a drill-down solve the missing definition if readers click into the detailed records?

08 • Dashboard designer: Detail can help investigation, but the overview still needs enough context to interpret its headline.

09 • Executive reader: I'll ask the metric owner for the target and comparison basis rather than guess them.

10 • Dashboard designer: I'll update the card once those are confirmed and show any missing context explicitly meanwhile.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A target is not an alert threshold

Fictional service dashboard: an agreed monthly target exists, but the team has not defined an operational alert threshold.

01 • Service manager: We have a monthly target. Can the dashboard send an alert whenever a daily result misses it?

02 • BI developer: A monthly target and a daily alert threshold answer different questions. We haven't defined that daily rule.

03 • Service manager: Could you explain the distinction without implying we should ignore daily performance completely?

04 • BI developer: The target describes a desired monthly outcome; an alert rule identifies conditions that need timely attention.

05 • Service manager: Then we need a reviewed daily interpretation rather than apply the monthly number to every day.

06 • BI developer: Exactly. Otherwise the dashboard may signal a problem based on an inappropriate comparison period.

07 • Service manager: I'll ask the operational owner what daily condition should trigger investigation and what context matters.

08 • BI developer: Please include the intended response, so the threshold supports an action rather than just another notification.

09 • Service manager: Until then, show daily data without presenting it as an approved pass-or-fail judgment.

10 • BI developer: Agreed. We can keep the monthly KPI and the proposed daily alert clearly separate.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A total can conceal where a service problem occurs

Fictional service report: an overall delay measure is available, but regional breakdowns have not been reviewed.

01 • Operations director: The overall delay measure is stable. Can I say every region is performing consistently?

02 • BI analyst: The total doesn't establish that. Regional differences could be hidden, and we haven't reviewed the breakdown.

03 • Operations director: So a drill-down lets us investigate variation, rather than assume the headline applies everywhere.

04 • BI analyst: Correct. It adds detail beneath the dashboard summary while retaining the same metric definition.

05 • Operations director: Should we label one region as the problem area before we open the underlying view?

06 • BI analyst: No. We don't have that evidence yet. The next step is inspection, not a regional conclusion.

07 • Operations director: Please provide a regional view with comparable periods and clearly identified missing data.

08 • BI analyst: I'll check the coverage and denominator so the drill-down doesn't introduce misleading comparisons.

09 • Operations director: Then the executive headline can state the overall result and note that regional analysis is pending.

10 • BI analyst: Yes. It will distinguish what the summary shows from what the detailed view still needs to establish.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Dashboards and Executive Reporting

A KPI card shows a monthly total without its target, comparison period, or definition. The reader cannot interpret whether the result is favorable.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Second round: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for scenario 1: The total needs context. I'll add the definition, reporting period, and relevant comparison so the reader can understand what changed and whether action is needed.

Scenario 2 | The arrow has no comparison label

A fictional KPI card shows 420 and an upward arrow. The comparison period and whether higher is favorable are unspecified. Discuss which labels are needed before the reader can interpret the arrow.

Role A: Dashboard analyst: explain the missing comparison basis.

Role B: Executive reader: ask what the arrow can and cannot mean.

Possible opening: The upward arrow needs a comparison period and metric context before we can call the change favorable.

Success checks

- Do not infer a period or desired direction.
- Distinguish movement from favorable performance.
- Request the metric owner's interpretation basis.

Add a complication: The reader asks to keep the arrow green because upward usually feels positive.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Causation, Correlation, and Caveats

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

SITUATION

Customers who attend training renew more often. Attendance was voluntary, and the groups may differ in motivation.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

correlation - A statistical association between variables; it does not by itself establish causation.

causation - A relationship in which a change in one factor produces a change in another.

confounder - A factor related to both a proposed cause and outcome that can distort their apparent relationship.

selection bias - Distortion caused by how people or observations are selected into a study or dataset.

3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Compare this wording: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

LESSON 04 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Match certainty to evidence

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
 - A. The change must have caused the delay.
 - B. The change definitely caused the delay.
 - C. The change may have contributed to the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
 - A. Across the service, the observed result was ...
 - B. In this pilot, the observed result was ...
 - C. In similar locations, we can now expect the same result ...

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Training attendance and renewal are associated

Fictional analysis discussion using the lesson case: training attendees renew more often, but attendance is voluntary and motivation may differ.

01 • Customer-success director: Training attendees renew more often. Can we say training caused the higher renewal rate?

02 • Analytics lead: The association is observed, but voluntary attendance creates a selection-bias concern about who chooses training.

03 • Customer-success director: You mean motivated customers might both attend and renew, even without a training effect?

04 • Analytics lead: That is one possible confounder, not a measured explanation we have confirmed in this case.

05 • Customer-success director: So correlation describes the pattern, while causation would require stronger support for the effect of attendance.

06 • Analytics lead: Exactly. We should not treat the group difference as an isolated training effect.

07 • Customer-success director: Can we still use the finding to propose further investigation rather than dismiss it as useless?

08 • Analytics lead: Yes. It raises a useful question and can inform a better-designed evaluation with appropriate review.

09 • Customer-success director: I'll describe attendees' higher renewal as an association and keep the motivation hypothesis explicitly tentative.

10 • Analytics lead: I'll bring the group definitions and limits so the recommendation doesn't promise an unestablished causal benefit.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Service time fell after two operational changes

Fictional operations analysis: average service time fell after both a staffing change and a new intake form; no separate effects were estimated.

01 • Operations manager: Service time fell after the new intake form. Can we credit the form for the improvement?

02 • Data analyst: Staffing changed during the same period, so the before-and-after comparison doesn't isolate the form's effect.

03 • Operations manager: Then the timing supports a question, but it doesn't rule out another explanation for the change.

04 • Data analyst: Correct. The staffing change is a potential confounder in this comparison, not a confirmed sole cause.

05 • Operations manager: Would saying staffing caused it instead be equally unsupported by the current evidence?

06 • Data analyst: Yes. We should describe the observed decrease and both concurrent changes without assigning causation.

07 • Operations manager: What can I recommend now without pretending the analysis has answered which change mattered?

08 • Data analyst: A focused investigation of comparable periods and available process data, with remaining limitations stated.

09 • Operations manager: I'll keep the operational result visible and replace the causal headline with a bounded description.

10 • Data analyst: I'll outline the evidence needed to examine the explanations rather than choose one by narrative appeal.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A survey describes respondents, not every customer

Fictional survey review: satisfied customers responded more often in a voluntary follow-up; nonrespondents' experiences are unknown.

01 • Experience manager: The voluntary follow-up looks positive. Can we say every customer group is satisfied with the service?

02 • Research analyst: The responses describe respondents. Nonrespondents' experiences are unknown, and participation may be related to satisfaction.

03 • Experience manager: We know satisfied customers responded more often here, so selection bias affects the broad interpretation.

04 • Research analyst: Yes. We should state that pattern without inventing what every nonrespondent would have said.

05 • Experience manager: Could we simply assign negative scores to missing responses to compensate for the bias?

06 • Research analyst: No. That would replace missing evidence with another unsupported assumption rather than solve the sampling problem.

07 • Experience manager: Then our result should report the respondent population and avoid a universal customer claim.

08 • Research analyst: Exactly. We can discuss further outreach or another evaluation approach without promising complete representativeness.

09 • Experience manager: I'll make the response boundary explicit and ask what additional evidence would inform the decision.

10 • Research analyst: I'll bring the participation pattern and limitations so the finding remains useful but appropriately bounded.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Causation, Correlation, and Caveats

Customers who attend training renew more often. Attendance was voluntary, and the groups may differ in motivation.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: Training attendance is associated with renewal in this dataset. That does not establish causation; the groups may differ in other ways. I'll state the finding with that limitation.

Scenario 2 | Adopting teams currently deliver more tasks

In a fictional company, teams that voluntarily adopted a planning tool deliver more tasks. Their performance before adoption has not been compared. Discuss the association and possible selection differences without declaring a tool effect.

Role A: Analytics lead: identify the missing baseline and causal limitation.

Role B: Program sponsor: ask what the current pattern can support.

Possible opening: Adopting teams deliver more tasks, but we haven't compared their performance before adoption.

Success checks

- State the observed association.
- Keep prior performance as an unassessed explanation.
- Recommend a bounded evidence check rather than guaranteed extrapolation.

Add a complication: The sponsor asks to multiply the difference across all teams as guaranteed benefit.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

SQL, Models, and Transformation Logic

Clarify missing information before responding.

SITUATION

A report joins order rows to several payment rows per order. Revenue appears larger after the join.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

SQL - Structured Query Language: a language for querying and working with relational data.

data model - A representation of how data is structured and how its elements relate.

grain - What one row or record represents in a dataset.

join logic - The rules used to connect records from different data tables.

3. Notice the language

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Compare this wording: Could you explain what does this mean?

LESSON 05 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask a precise question

4. Check the language

1. Which indirect question has the usual word order?
 - A. Could you confirm when starts the review?
 - B. Could you confirm when the review starts?
 - C. Could you confirm when does the review start?
2. Someone says the report is 'ready.' Which question best clarifies its approval status?
 - A. Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?
 - B. Can you send the report to me this afternoon?
 - C. Who will present the report at the meeting?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Several payment rows multiply order revenue

Fictional SQL review using the lesson case: order rows join to several payment rows per order, and reported revenue increases after the join.

01 • Reporting analyst: Revenue grows after I join payments. Could you clarify the grain of each source table?

02 • Data engineer: Orders has one row per order; payments can have several rows for the same order.

03 • Reporting analyst: Then an order's revenue may appear repeatedly when its row matches multiple payment records.

04 • Data engineer: Yes. Check that relationship before assuming the larger total represents additional business activity.

05 • Reporting analyst: Would adding DISTINCT to the SQL automatically fix the report without changing its meaning?

06 • Data engineer: Not necessarily. We need the intended reporting grain and measure definition before choosing the transformation.

07 • Reporting analyst: The report is intended to summarize order revenue. I'll confirm how payment details should contribute.

08 • Data engineer: Please inspect matched row counts and a small traceable example with the same join logic.

09 • Reporting analyst: I'll retain the original totals and compare the transformation against those known source records.

10 • Data engineer: Then we can choose logic that preserves the intended unit rather than hide multiplication with an unexplained filter.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A customer changes regions over time

Fictional data-model review: the customer table stores multiple dated region records, and a report joins orders using customer ID alone.

01 • BI developer: My regional order report duplicates some orders. Does the customer table contain one row per customer?

02 • Data modeler: No. It contains dated region records, so a customer can have several rows over time.

03 • BI developer: Then joining only on customer ID doesn't specify which historical region should apply to an order.

04 • Data modeler: Correct. We need the reporting question: region at order time or the customer's current region?

05 • BI developer: That business rule isn't documented. I shouldn't choose the latest row simply because it removes duplicates.

06 • Data modeler: Exactly. A convenient SQL result could answer the wrong business question even with plausible totals.

07 • BI developer: I'll ask the metric owner which time relationship is intended before changing the join logic.

08 • Data modeler: Please also check how overlapping or missing validity periods should be handled, rather than silently guessing.

09 • BI developer: I'll bring those edge cases with a small sample and keep the current report marked under review.

10 • Data modeler: Then the transformation can reflect an explicit grain and time rule instead of accidental matching.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A daily snapshot is not a daily addition

Fictional warehouse report: an inventory table contains daily balance snapshots, and a draft report sums them as if they were daily receipts.

01 • Operations analyst: The monthly inventory number looks huge. Does this table record daily receipts or daily balance snapshots?

02 • Data engineer: It records a balance snapshot for each item each day, not newly received units.

03 • Operations analyst: Then summing every day's balance counts the same continuing stock repeatedly across the month.

04 • Data engineer: Correct. We need to clarify whether the report wants an ending balance, an average, or another measure.

05 • Operations analyst: I shouldn't select month-end automatically because the business question hasn't been confirmed yet.

06 • Data engineer: Exactly. First establish the measure and grain; then choose the SQL transformation that answers it.

07 • Operations analyst: Could you identify the snapshot date field and any days missing from the source?

08 • Data engineer: I'll provide that context, but the business owner still needs to confirm the intended inventory question.

09 • Operations analyst: I'll ask them and compare a small item history before changing the dashboard calculation.

10 • Data engineer: Good. The corrected logic should reflect what the rows mean, not merely produce a smaller number.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | SQL, Models, and Transformation Logic

A report joins order rows to several payment rows per order. Revenue appears larger after the join.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: What does one row represent in each table? The join may repeat order values when there are multiple payments. Let's check the grain and aggregation before interpreting the total.

Scenario 2 | One customer appears in several campaign groups

A fictional customer table joins to campaign membership with multiple rows per customer. The report requests unique customers reached, but the draft counts joined rows. Clarify the unit and join relationship without prescribing an unexplained SQL shortcut.

Role A: BI analyst: ask about membership grain and the desired customer measure.

Role B: Marketing data owner: distinguish campaign memberships from unique people.

Possible opening: Does each joined row represent a customer or a campaign membership for that customer?

Success checks

- Identify the one-to-many relationship.
- Use the intended entity and verified identifier.
- Agree a traceable sample check before changing the calculation.

Add a complication: The owner suggests deleting repeated names, although different customers can share names.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Experiment Readouts and Statistical Thinking

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

SITUATION

An experiment estimates a positive effect, but the interval includes values close to no change. The slide presents only the point estimate.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

sample size - The number of independent units or observations included in a defined analysis.

effect size - A measure of the magnitude of a difference or relationship.

confidence interval - An interval produced by a method with a stated long-run coverage rate under its assumptions.

guardrail - A boundary or protective check used to prevent an unacceptable outcome.

3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Compare this wording: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

LESSON 06 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Match certainty to evidence

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
 - A. The change may have contributed to the delay.
 - B. The change must have caused the delay.
 - C. The change definitely caused the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
 - A. In similar locations, we can now expect the same result ...
 - B. Across the service, the observed result was ...
 - C. In this pilot, the observed result was ...

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The estimate needs its uncertainty interval

Fictional experiment readout using the lesson case: the point estimate is positive, but its interval includes values near no change; the slide omits the interval.

01 • Decision sponsor: The slide shows a positive effect. Can I treat that number as the established improvement?

02 • Experiment analyst: It is the point estimate. Its confidence interval includes values close to no change, which the slide omits.

03 • Decision sponsor: So the estimate summarizes the observed result, but the uncertainty affects how strongly we should interpret it.

04 • Experiment analyst: Yes. We should present the effect size and interval together, using the method's stated assumptions.

05 • Decision sponsor: Does an interval near no change prove that the treatment has no useful effect?

06 • Experiment analyst: No. It indicates uncertainty under the analysis; it doesn't justify that opposite certainty either.

07 • Decision sponsor: Please also include sample size and the guardrail results so one favorable number doesn't carry the decision.

08 • Experiment analyst: I'll check those records and distinguish completed analysis from any results still pending.

09 • Decision sponsor: Then the recommendation can reflect practical importance and uncertainty instead of promising the point estimate.

10 • Experiment analyst: Agreed. I'll revise the readout so its conclusion stays within the evidence we actually have.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A relative lift needs the absolute change

Fictional experiment: conversion rises from 2% to 2.2%; uncertainty analysis and guardrail review are not complete.

01 • Product sponsor: A ten percent lift sounds substantial. Is that the clearest way to present this conversion result?

02 • Data scientist: Include the absolute change too: two percent to two-point-two percent is a zero-point-two percentage-point increase.

03 • Product sponsor: Then ten percent describes relative change, not ten additional percentage points of conversion.

04 • Data scientist: Correct. Both can be reported, but the distinction matters when judging practical effect size.

05 • Product sponsor: Can the size of the relative lift tell us the result is statistically reliable?

06 • Data scientist: Not by itself. Uncertainty analysis is incomplete, and the guardrail review is still pending.

07 • Product sponsor: I'll keep the observed rates but avoid calling the treatment a confirmed success today.

08 • Data scientist: Please also include the sample-size context once verified, rather than presenting the percentage without its basis.

09 • Product sponsor: At the readout, we'll ask whether the effect is useful and supported, not just whether it sounds large.

10 • Data scientist: I'll bring the completed analysis and clearly identify any remaining uncertainty before that decision.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

An unplanned subgroup result needs a caveat

Fictional experiment review: the overall estimate is modest, and an exploratory subgroup shows a larger estimate; the subgroup was selected after examining results.

01 • Business lead: This subgroup has a much larger estimate. Can we make it the headline experiment result?

02 • Experiment analyst: It was selected after we examined the results, so we should label that analysis exploratory.

03 • Business lead: Does exploratory mean the observed subgroup estimate is wrong and should be removed entirely?

04 • Experiment analyst: No. It can suggest a follow-up question, but it doesn't have the same status as the planned comparison.

05 • Business lead: We also need its sample size and uncertainty, rather than assume a bigger estimate is more dependable.

06 • Experiment analyst: Exactly. Smaller subgroups and multiple examined comparisons can complicate interpretation under the chosen analysis.

07 • Business lead: I'll keep the overall result visible and describe the subgroup as a hypothesis-generating observation.

08 • Experiment analyst: Good. We should retain the selection history instead of rewriting it as a prespecified test.

09 • Business lead: Could we propose a targeted future evaluation without promising the larger effect will repeat?

10 • Experiment analyst: Yes. That is a bounded recommendation, with the current evidence and guardrail questions clearly stated.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Experiment Readouts and Statistical Thinking

An experiment estimates a positive effect, but the interval includes values close to no change. The slide presents only the point estimate.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: I'll show the estimated effect and its uncertainty together. The point estimate alone hides the range of values compatible with the analysis and can make the result sound more certain than it is.

Scenario 2 | A larger sample from a different population

A fictional team proposes combining a small customer experiment with a large employee trial to increase sample size. The populations differ, and comparability has not been assessed. Discuss why more observations alone do not settle the interpretation.

Role A: Experiment analyst: explain the population mismatch.

Role B: Decision sponsor: ask whether separate results would be more informative.

Possible opening: Combining the trials increases the count, but we haven't established that employees and customers answer the same research question.

Success checks

- Distinguish precision from population relevance.
- Do not claim a pooled effect is valid before review.
- Agree to assess comparability and report groups transparently.

Add a complication: The sponsor asks to pool them without a caveat because the interval may become narrower.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Data Governance and Privacy

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

SITUATION

An analyst wants customer-level data but has not specified which fields are needed or how long they will be retained.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

data governance - The responsibilities and rules for managing data quality, access, use, and protection.

privacy - The appropriate handling of personal information and individuals' related interests and rights.

access control - Rules and mechanisms that determine who may use information or a system.

retention - Keeping customers, users, staff, or records over a stated period; specify which meaning applies.

3. Notice the language

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know

Compare this wording: Please revert soonest with the necessary.

LESSON 07 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask for an actionable next step

4. Check the language

1. What does 'Please send it by Thursday' normally mean?
 - A. Send it on Thursday, but not earlier.
 - B. Keep sending it regularly until Thursday.
 - C. Send it no later than Thursday.
2. Which request gives the recipient enough detail to act?
 - A. Could you confirm that you received my earlier message?
 - B. Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?
 - C. Could you confirm that the review is important?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Which customer fields are actually needed?

Fictional governance request using the lesson case: an analyst requests customer-level data without specifying fields or retention duration.

01 • Data steward: Could you specify the fields, analytical purpose, and requested retention period for this customer-level dataset?

02 • Analyst: I asked for the full table, but I haven't explained which variables answer my question.

03 • Data steward: Please narrow that request before access review so privacy and access-control requirements can be assessed.

04 • Analyst: Would removing names mean the entire table is automatically appropriate for my analysis?

05 • Data steward: No. Other fields may remain sensitive or identifying, and authorization still needs to be checked.

06 • Analyst: I'll describe the question and ask whether an aggregated dataset could answer it instead.

07 • Data steward: Good. Also state the requested review timing without treating urgency as approval to bypass governance.

08 • Analyst: I'll submit the scoped request before our planning meeting and identify retention as needing owner confirmation.

09 • Data steward: I'll return any missing-information questions through the approved channel and keep access pending review.

10 • Analyst: Understood. I won't download customer-level records while the authorized scope is still unresolved.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An external collaborator needs a reviewed extract

Fictional analytics collaboration: an external researcher requests transaction-level records; field necessity, authorization, and transfer method are unconfirmed.

01 • Research coordinator: Our collaborator wants the transaction-level file. Could you send it so the analysis can begin?

02 • Data governance lead: First provide the purpose, required fields, recipient details, and proposed retention period for review.

03 • Research coordinator: They already work with us on another project. Does that previous collaboration establish access here?

04 • Data governance lead: Not automatically. This dataset and purpose need their own authorization and appropriate secure-handling assessment.

05 • Research coordinator: Could we ask whether a smaller aggregate extract would meet the same analytical need?

06 • Data governance lead: Yes. That is a useful scope question, but the proposed extract still needs the applicable review.

07 • Research coordinator: I'll request the collaborator's minimum requirements and avoid sending records through ordinary email meanwhile.

08 • Data governance lead: Please include the needed decision timing so the responsible owners can coordinate their response.

09 • Research coordinator: I'll explain that analysis start remains conditional on approved access and transfer arrangements.

10 • Data governance lead: Good. We'll assess a specific request rather than infer permission from an existing professional relationship.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A temporary extract remains in a shared folder

Fictional data review: an extract created for a completed analysis remains in a shared folder; its authorized retention period is unknown.

01 • Analytics manager: The analysis is finished, but its temporary extract is still in the shared folder.

02 • Data steward: Please identify the extract owner and approved retention basis before deciding what should happen next.

03 • Analytics manager: Could we delete it immediately because temporary always means it should disappear after the presentation?

04 • Data steward: We shouldn't invent a retention rule. Check the applicable requirements and any legitimate preservation obligations with the owner.

05 • Analytics manager: The authorized retention period isn't recorded here, so both continued storage and deletion need clarification.

06 • Data steward: Correct. Also confirm current access scope through the established review process rather than assuming the folder is restricted.

07 • Analytics manager: I'll request the retention and access records today and flag the missing documentation explicitly.

08 • Data steward: Thank you. Avoid copying the extract into another location just to make the review easier.

09 • Analytics manager: I'll provide its reference and purpose through the governance channel, keeping the data in place pending direction.

10 • Data steward: Then the authorized owner can decide the appropriate handling based on actual requirements, not a guessed deadline.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Data Governance and Privacy

An analyst wants customer-level data but has not specified which fields are needed or how long they will be retained.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Second round: The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Model for scenario 1: Could you define the analysis purpose, necessary fields, and retention period? That will let the appropriate team review access and privacy requirements before the data is shared.

Scenario 2 | A screenshot includes customer identifiers

A fictional analyst wants to show a dashboard screenshot in an external presentation. Customer identifiers are visible, and publication approval has not been checked. Request a reviewed alternative without declaring that simple masking guarantees privacy.

Role A: Data steward: ask what information the presentation needs and who approves sharing.

Role B: Analyst: propose a synthetic or aggregated example for review.

Possible opening: The screenshot includes customer identifiers; could we use a reviewed example that contains only what the presentation needs?

Success checks

- Distinguish reduced exposure from verified approval.
- Request the minimum necessary presentation content.
- Keep external sharing pending the appropriate review.

Add a complication: The analyst says cropping the names alone proves the image is safe.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Insight Storytelling and Recommendations

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

SITUATION

A report lists ten findings but no recommended action. The audience has five minutes to decide whether to investigate a service issue.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

insight - An interpretation of evidence that improves understanding of a question or decision.

recommendation - A proposed action supported by reasons and relevant evidence.

assumption - Something treated as true for planning or reasoning, though it may need verification.

next best action - The action judged most useful for a stated objective given current information.

3. Notice the language

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Compare this wording: We need to operationalize the implementation.

LESSON 08 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Make a complex point clear

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence explains 'backlog' rather than repeating it?
 - A. The backlog is the maximum work the team can finish in a period.
 - B. The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.
 - C. The backlog is the work completed during the last period.
2. Which follow-up best checks whether your explanation was clear?
 - A. How would you describe the next step in your own words?
 - B. Would you like me to repeat the explanation?
 - C. Was the explanation detailed enough for you?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Ten findings need one decision-focused recommendation

Separate fictional executive readout: a report lists ten findings. Eight of ten delayed service tickets lack handoff timestamps, preventing a complete timeline reconstruction. The cause of delay and reason for the missing timestamps are unknown. The audience has five minutes to consider an investigation.

01 • Service director: We have five minutes. What decision does this report support?

02 • BI analyst: A focused service investigation, not acceptance of an unconfirmed cause.

03 • Service director: How does an insight differ from a recommendation?

04 • BI analyst: An insight interprets a pattern; a recommendation proposes action based on evidence and its limits.

05 • Service director: Which findings support that next best action, and which are only background for today's decision?

06 • BI analyst: Eight of ten delayed tickets lack handoff timestamps. Reviewing how handoffs are recorded could clarify the incomplete service timeline.

07 • Service director: Don't invent a cause to make the story sound decisive.

08 • BI analyst: Agreed. The missing timestamps don't explain the delays. I propose that the service owner review those eight ticket histories.

09 • Service director: Then end with the decision ask: whether to authorize that investigation, not whether to accept an unproven explanation.

10 • BI analyst: Please authorize that bounded records review; it could identify available timeline evidence, but its findings and the delay cause remain unknown.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A queue pattern suggests where to look first

Fictional service analysis: delays are concentrated in the intake queue during the observed week; staffing and demand causes have not been assessed.

01 • Operations sponsor: The intake queue has most of the observed delay. Should we immediately add more staff there?

02 • Analytics lead: The pattern identifies where to investigate, but it doesn't establish staffing as the cause or solution.

03 • Operations sponsor: Then what is the useful insight, and how does it differ from a hiring recommendation?

04 • Analytics lead: The insight is the concentration of delay in intake during this week. Hiring requires additional evidence and authority.

05 • Operations sponsor: Could the next best action be to review intake demand and handling steps with the process owner?

06 • Analytics lead: Yes. That is bounded and directly related to the observed pattern without assuming the explanation.

07 • Operations sponsor: Please state the week in the headline so readers don't interpret this as a permanent condition.

08 • Analytics lead: I'll do that and identify any measurement limitations before we generalize to other periods.

09 • Operations sponsor: I'll authorize a discussion with the process owner, not an immediate staffing change from this chart.

10 • Analytics lead: I'll bring the supporting breakdown and frame the open question clearly for that investigation.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Recommend a check before replacing a supplier

Fictional delivery analysis: one supplier has a higher recorded late-delivery rate, but requested delivery windows differ across suppliers.

01 • Procurement manager: This supplier has the highest recorded late rate. Should the recommendation be to replace them?

02 • BI analyst: Not yet. Requested delivery windows differ, so the raw ranking isn't a matched performance comparison.

03 • Procurement manager: Then the report should explain that limitation before presenting replacement as the next best action.

04 • BI analyst: Correct. A useful recommendation is to compare equivalent delivery commitments and verify how lateness is defined.

05 • Procurement manager: Does that mean we should ignore the observed ranking until a perfect dataset exists?

06 • BI analyst: No. Retain it as a signal for investigation, with the comparison assumption clearly stated.

07 • Procurement manager: Can you give the procurement team a focused question rather than ten possible analyses?

08 • BI analyst: Ask whether the difference persists when comparable requested windows and counting rules are used.

09 • Procurement manager: I'll request that review before making a supplier decision, and keep other decision criteria separate.

10 • BI analyst: I'll deliver the bounded comparison and distinguish what it reveals from any commercial recommendation requiring broader judgment.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Insight Storytelling and Recommendations

A report lists ten findings but no recommended action. The audience has five minutes to decide whether to investigate a service issue.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Second round: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for scenario 1: I'll lead with the finding relevant to that decision, explain its limitation, and recommend a specific investigation. The other findings can support the discussion without obscuring the request.

Scenario 2 | A recommendation depends on an unverified address field

A fictional report recommends contacting customers in one region, but the region field may refer to billing rather than service location. The field definition is unverified. Explain why the next action should begin with clarification.

Role A: Analytics lead: identify the assumption beneath the recommendation.

Role B: Service manager: ask what can be decided before outreach begins.

Possible opening: The outreach recommendation depends on what region means, and that field definition is still unverified.

Success checks

- State the dependency between definition and action.
- Avoid presenting billing location as confirmed service location.
- Recommend an owner-confirmed definition check before outreach.

Add a complication: The manager wants to contact the listed customers first and clarify afterward.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response to scenario 1, not a script to memorize. Assess your spoken version using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Metric Definitions and Business Questions

Editing example: Could you explain what this means?

After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Check 1: C - Could you confirm when the review starts?

A: Remove 'does' and use statement word order after 'confirm'.

B: Place the subject 'the review' before 'starts'.

C: The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".

Check 2: B - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

A: This asks about the presenter, not the report's approval status.

B: This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

C: This asks about delivery timing, not whether approval has happened.

Model response: What action qualifies a user as active, and over what period? The two totals use different definitions. Let's agree on the business question and label each measure clearly.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Data Quality and Trust

Editing example: Three checks are complete; two remain open and are being reviewed.

The revision gives observable progress. A positive label alone does not tell the reader what is complete or still needed.

Check 1: B - The team has completed the review.

A: 'Plans to complete' describes an intention, not completion.

B: 'Has completed' states that the action is finished.

C: 'Is completing' presents the work as in progress.

Check 2: A - Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.

A: This explicitly labels the date as planned and identifies the missing confirmation.

B: A plan does not establish carrier confirmation.

C: A plan cannot prove a future arrival time.

Model response: The dashboard refreshed today, but that table is current only through Monday. I'll show the source's data cutoff separately from the dashboard refresh time.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Dashboards and Executive Reporting

Editing example: We need to put the plan into practice.

The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Check 1: A - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.

A: This gives the meaning in familiar words.

B: Completed work is different from work still waiting.

C: This describes capacity, not the work waiting to be completed.

Check 2: C - How would you describe the next step in your own words?

A: Offering repetition may help, but it does not show how the listener understood the next step.

B: This invites an opinion on detail, not a demonstration of understanding.

C: An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

Model response: The total needs context. I'll add the definition, reporting period, and relevant comparison so the reader can understand what changed and whether action is needed.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Causation, Correlation, and Caveats

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Check 1: C - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

B: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

C: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

Check 2: B - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: A pilot in one location does not establish a service-wide observation.

B: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

C: Similarity alone does not establish that the result will transfer.

Model response: Training attendance is associated with renewal in this dataset. That does not establish causation; the groups may differ in other ways. I'll state the finding with that limitation.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | SQL, Models, and Transformation Logic

Editing example: Could you explain what this means?

After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Check 1: B - Could you confirm when the review starts?

A: Place the subject 'the review' before 'starts'.

B: The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".

C: Remove 'does' and use statement word order after 'confirm'.

Check 2: A - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

A: This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

B: This asks about delivery timing, not whether approval has happened.

C: This asks about the presenter, not the report's approval status.

Model response: What does one row represent in each table? The join may repeat order values when there are multiple payments. Let's check the grain and aggregation before interpreting the total.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Experiment Readouts and Statistical Thinking

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Check 1: A - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

B: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

C: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

Check 2: C - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: Similarity alone does not establish that the result will transfer.

B: A pilot in one location does not establish a service-wide observation.

C: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

Model response: I'll show the estimated effect and its uncertainty together. The point estimate alone hides the range of values compatible with the analysis and can make the result sound more certain than it is.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Data Governance and Privacy

Editing example: Could you send the missing document and confirm when it will be available?

The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Check 1: C - Send it no later than Thursday.

A: "By Thursday" permits earlier delivery; it is not restricted to that day.

B: This interprets a deadline as a continuing activity, which would use "until".

C: 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.

Check 2: B - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?

A: This checks receipt, not which version is required for the review.

B: The requested action and information are explicit.

C: This checks importance rather than identifying the needed document version.

Model response: Could you define the analysis purpose, necessary fields, and retention period? That will let the appropriate team review access and privacy requirements before the data is shared.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Insight Storytelling and Recommendations

Editing example: We need to put the plan into practice.

The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Check 1: B - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.

A: This describes capacity, not the work waiting to be completed.

B: This gives the meaning in familiar words.

C: Completed work is different from work still waiting.

Check 2: A - How would you describe the next step in your own words?

A: An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

B: Offering repetition may help, but it does not show how the listener understood the next step.

C: This invites an opinion on detail, not a demonstration of understanding.

Model response: I'll lead with the finding relevant to that decision, explain its limitation, and recommend a specific investigation. The other findings can support the discussion without obscuring the request.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the next two prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Writing feedback begins with your draft. Vocabulary, grammar and review prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has eight practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

The two starter prompts use B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-28. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Practice grammar in context

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Data Analytics and Business Intelligence English

Professional audience: data analysts, BI developers, analytics engineers, data scientists, reporting teams, business analysts, and data-driven managers

Scope: All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Lesson 01: Metric Definitions and Business Questions

Original fictional case: Two teams report different active-user totals. One counts logins; the other counts completed transactions.

Language workshop: Ask a precise question

Communication goal: Clarify missing information before responding.

Language guidance: Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): When you say ..., do you mean ...? / Could you clarify which ...? / So, my understanding is Is that right?

Vocabulary: metric: A defined quantitative measure used to track or assess something. / business definition: An agreed explanation of what a measure or term means in an organization. / source of truth: The agreed authoritative reference for a particular item of organizational information. / owner: Named person or role accountable for a decision, action, deliverable, or risk.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Writing task: Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Optional second-round challenge: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: What action qualifies a user as active, and over what period? The two totals use different definitions. Let's agree on the business question and label each measure clearly.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Grammar that changes the meaning

1. For a lesson, use its language workshop as the focus. For a dialogue, quote one actual sentence and select one useful grammar feature from it, such as question word order, tense, modality, conditionals or clause linking. Explain in no more than 90 words how this feature helps the speakers do their work. Keep the grammar target narrow.
2. Give two short contrasting sentences using this workplace context. Explain the difference in time, certainty, condition or politeness. Label invented examples and preserve the distinction between possible, planned and confirmed events. Describe context-dependent choices as choices, not universal rules.
3. Give me one editing or sentence-building task using a known case fact. Do not copy the supplied editing example or reveal its answer. Ask me to explain my intended meaning. Stop and wait.
4. After I answer, quote my wording, identify at most two issues, and give a brief explanation and one hint. Ask me to revise before offering a full corrected version. Then accept any accurate, natural alternative that serves the purpose.
5. Continue with two new tasks, one at a time: first guided, then an original response without a sentence frame. End with a two-sentence workplace message using the target feature and a compact self-check. Do not replace this sequence with a worksheet and answer key.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level

Get feedback on a draft

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

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When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

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Optional second-round challenge: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: What action qualifies a user as active, and over what period? The two totals use different definitions. Let's agree on the business question and label each measure clearly.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Coach my workplace writing

1. Ask me to paste my own fictional or anonymized draft and identify its reader and purpose. If the reference gives a writing task, mention that task as the default. If it is a dialogue, suggest a brief follow-up message that records its outcome and open questions. Stop and wait. Do not write the message for me first.
2. Once I supply the draft, check it against the reference. If an ambiguity changes the meaning, ask one focused question before rewriting. Do not assume that the draft is correct evidence for a new deadline, approval, diagnosis, cost or commitment.
3. Give feedback in three parts: one effective phrase with a reason; up to three priority improvements, quoting my words; and one short revision task for me. Prioritize incorrect facts or unclear action before minor grammar. For each language correction, explain why it matters to this reader. Label optional stylistic alternatives separately and preserve my level of certainty and intended politeness.
4. Stop and wait for my revision. Then compare the two attempts, identify an improvement and offer one edited version that preserves my voice and purpose. Keep the requested length; if none is specified, use 70-110 words. Explain any meaningful change rather than silently making the message stronger or more certain.
5. Close with one phrase worth reusing and a short transfer task for a different fictional reader. Wait for my attempt before providing another model.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level